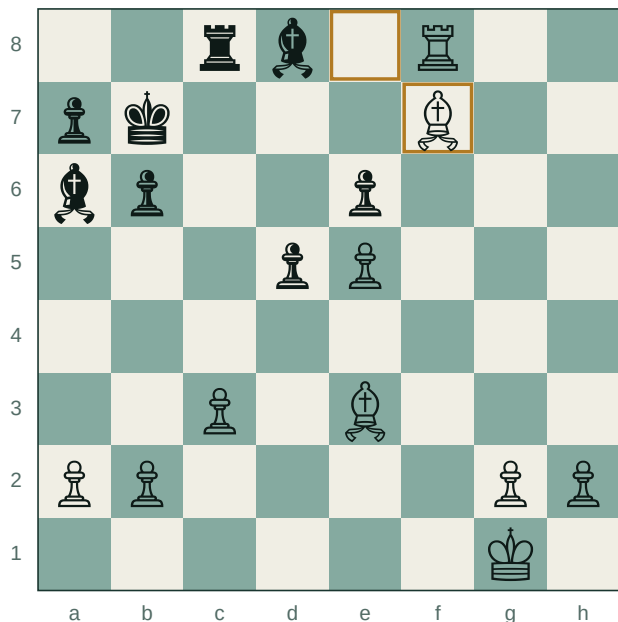


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 28

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 28.Bf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28...Bg5 29. Rxc8 Bxe3+ 30. Kh1 Kxc8

28...Bg5 The bishop moves from d8 to g5. The changed line means the rook on c8 attacks the rook on f8. Recorded reply: **29.Rxc8**.

29...Bxe3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **30.Kh1**.

30...Kxc8 The king captures the rook on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on f8 and bishop on e3. Check for tactical protection.